

HONGXUAN JI Ji Hongxuan · 嵇鸿轩

Art Historian & Material-Culture Researcher • Anthropological Fieldworker (secondary line: ceramic sculpture)

+86 133 0234 0686 • kekogen@foxmail.com • Based in Jingdezhen, Jiangxi • b. 1999



Research Profile

Research is my main line, with interests concentrated in anthropology, material culture and iconography: history taught me to question through primary sources and the site itself, art history to read images and date them, anthropology to put objects and ritual back among the people who make them. Three threads run through my work — funerary architectural imagery and Sino-Western visual hybridity in Macao; intangible heritage, fieldwork and oral history in western Guangdong and eastern Guizhou; and the production and identity of the Jingdezhen handicraft community. To date: two journal articles, one master’s thesis, five international conference presentations.

Research interests: Material Culture & Handicraft • Funerary Architecture & Iconography • Intangible Heritage, Fieldwork & Oral History • Digital Safeguarding of Cultural Heritage • Area Studies & Cross-Cultural Exchange

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Education

Macao University of Science and Technology • Master of Fine Arts, History of Fine Arts 2022 — 2024  
Faculty of Humanities and Arts. Thesis: *A Study of Macao Funerary Architectural Imagery* — architectural ethnography, documentary research, iconography and iconology applied to a full survey of structure, form and imagery across the 17 cemeteries extant in Macao; held in the MUST Library thesis repository.

Jingdezhen Ceramic University • Sculpture 2024 — 2026  
Academy of Fine Arts; two-year full-time programme (second bachelor’s degree), average 85.2, GPA 3.52 / 4.

Guangdong University of Petrochemical Technology • BA, History 2018 — 2022  
School of Humanities and Law. Thesis: *On the Causes of the Failure of Japanese Socialism*. First-class scholarship; outstanding graduate.

Publications

2 journal articles (sole author) • 1 master’s thesis • 5 international conference presentations

Journal articles

Fieldwork on the Zhangtian Cake Moulds of Guangdong: with a Discussion of Their Imagery from the Perspective of Folkloric Iconography 2024

MinYi (Folk Arts) 2024(1), ISSN 2096-5257 — fieldwork and iconographic analysis of the meanings carved into cake moulds. Representative work.

In Search of the Revolutionary Sites of Maoming 2021  
Yanhuang Geography 2021(6), pp. 98-100, ISSN 2095-6185 — written alongside the Maoming revolutionary-site survey.

Master’s thesis

A Study of Macao Funerary Architectural Imagery 2024  
MUST master’s thesis (English title: A Study on the Architectural Images of Tombstones in Macao); defended June 2024.

Conference papers and oral presentations

The Historical Evolution of Macao’s Burial Grounds and Its Lessons for Mutual Learning among Civilisations 2026.09  
Area Studies • Beijing Forum 2026 (Beijing International Studies University), panel presentation.

The Forgotten Emotional Geography: Emotion, Memory and Cross-Cultural Empathy in the Cemeteries and Tombstone Architecture of Modern Macao 2026.08

3rd International Symposium on Global South Studies (USSH-VNUHCM, Vietnam); abstract review 3.83/5.

Space and Culture: A Study on the Historical Evolution of Cemeteries and Tombstone Architecture in Modern Macao 2026.05  
International migration and intercultural communication student congress, University of Edinburgh; 15-minute paper; forthcoming in *sine*.

Same paper • Lingnan University session 2026.04  
Postgraduate Conference 2026, Lingnan University (Hong Kong): oral presentation of the same paper.

Symbiotic Order and Identity Adjustment in Ritual Practice: Fieldwork on Village Beliefs among the Tujia of Yinjiang, Guizhou 2025.08

Symposium on intangible heritage and rural development, Guiyang; paper no. KSK-2025-011.

Research Projects

“Investigating China” (Southern Weekly/Nanfengchuang) — Jingdezhen Ceramic Handicraft Practitioners • Research team member 2024

Producing the Complete Person: Jingdezhen ceramic handicraft practitioners — national top ten, Third Prize and Best Fieldwork Record Award; responsible for research design, interviews, survey, filming and report writing.

Fieldwork on Guangdong Intangible Heritage: the Zhangtian Cake Moulds • Principal investigator 2022 — 2023  
Interviews with inheritors and process documentation; iconographic analysis of mould patterns; report won the 3rd “Recording Rural China” Excellence Award; results in MinYi 2024(1).

Survey of Revolutionary Sites in Maoming, Guangdong • Principal investigator 2020 — 2021  
Systematic survey of revolutionary sites in urban Maoming with the municipal Party-history office: measuring and recording present conditions, collecting oral histories, writing fieldwork reports; funded as university and provincial innovation projects.

Fieldwork & Practice

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Village Gazetteer of Zhongyao Village, Yinjiang, Guizhou • Editorial member                                                                                                     | 2024.12 — 2025.01 |
| Fieldwork and gazetteer writing on a Tujia village; its history and folkways documented through oral accounts, stelae and images.                                               |                   |
| Artist Residency, Yumen City Museum, Gansu • Artist in residence                                                                                                                | 2024.08 — 2024.10 |
| “Changma Shirui” phase II: restorative copying of murals in Caves 2 and 4 of the Changma Grottoes; documentation of c. 140 m² of mural material; results donated to the museum. |                   |

Awards • Academic & Research

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| 7th “Guangqi Cup” National Student Paper Competition in Art Disciplines • Third Prize, undergraduate division — paper: A Study of Macao Funerary Architectural Imagery                                                      | 2026.05 |
| 5th “Recording Rural China” University Student Folk-Culture Social Survey • Second Prize — Not-a-Horse: the Reconstruction of Horse Culture in Paper-Horse Ritual, based on fieldwork among several ethnic groups in Yunnan | 2026.05 |
| 37th Han Suyin International Translation Competition • Excellence Award, Japanese – Chinese                                                                                                                                 | 2025.11 |
| 4th “Recording Rural China” University Student Folk-Culture Social Survey • Second Prize — fieldwork on village beliefs among the Tujia of Yinjiang, Tongren, Guizhou                                                       | 2025.04 |
| 3rd “Recording Rural China” University Student Folk-Culture Social Survey • Excellence Award — Zhangtian Cake Mould fieldwork report (Henan Centre for Oral and Intangible Cultural Heritage)                               | 2024.01 |
| 17th “Challenge Cup” National Undergraduate Extracurricular Academic Science & Technology Works Competition • National Second Prize                                                                                         | 2022.03 |
| 16th “Challenge Cup” Guangdong Undergraduate Academic Science & Technology Works Competition • Provincial First Prize                                                                                                       | 2021.07 |
| Fragrance of Steed Bones selected for the 9th Jiangxi Provincial Zodiac Sculpture Exhibition [creative work]                                                                                                                | 2026.02 |

Programmes • Method & International Courses

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| China National Arts Fund 2026 — Innovative Craft Talent Training Programme, Shouzhou Kiln          | 2026.07 | Peking University graduate summer school: Theory and Method of Built-Environment Cultural Heritage — River-Civilisation | 2026.04 |
| QualiTaTi Summer School • AI for Qualitative Research (grade A • 90.33/100)                        | 2026.07 | Durham, Oxford et al. • Endangered Archaeology: Protecting Cultural Heritage with Remote Sensing                        | 2026.03 |
| 6th National Undergraduate Anthropology Training Camp, Zhejiang University (also the 5th, 2025.06) | 2026.06 |                                                                                                                         |         |

Languages • Methods • Other Competence

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| Languages: Japanese JLPT N1 (2019), CJT-6 (2026), College Japanese Test Band 4 (2024); English CET-4 (511); Putonghua Level 2-B (83.4); Cantonese and Hakka (mother tongues); Latin, Sumerian and Akkadian (coursework)                                                                                                                       |  | Creative practice & certification (secondary): Ceramic sculpture selected for the 9th Jiangxi Provincial Zodiac Sculpture Exhibition and awarded at the “Chaojiao Liyong Cup” young ceramists competition; Tile Cat collected by the Hainan Zijin Ceramic Art Museum. Also holds senior-high-school teacher qualification (Japanese), Ceramic Craft Maker and Tea Taster certification. |  |
| Methods and tools: Fieldwork and oral history; iconography and iconology; AI-assisted qualitative research (NVivo coding); foundations of big-data analysis and causal inference; SAS Visual Analytics; remote-sensing archaeology and 3D modelling (C4D, ZBrush, structured-light scanning); archaeological ceramic restoration and kintsugi |  | Certificates, transcripts and article PDFs available on request; originals on the personal website.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |